

Vertex Pharmaceuticals Inc. (VRTX): 2Q earnings preview: Facing an eventful 2H

VRTX shares have underperformed the sector and broader market YTD (-5% vs. DRG, vs. -2% vs. S&P 500), as SION's likely August Phase 2 data in cystic fibrosis (CF; evaluating an add-on to VRTX's standard-of-care Trikafta) has served as an overhang. While SION has framed the bar-for-success as a 10mmol/L reduction on key biomarker sweat chloride (SwCl), for VRTX shares the bar is higher and we will evaluate the data in the context of its portfolio and ongoing serial innovation in CF (see our note [here](#)). Post, we see it as attractively positioned into: 1) the povetacicept launch in IgA nephropathy, noting a November 30 PDUFA, a new product cycle - in our view, the totality of the data to-date (hematuria and monthly administration, key in the context of a chronic therapy) supports best-in-class potential, and 2) data from the CRNX assets given the [proposed acquisition](#), including Phase 2 open-label extension atumelnant data in congenital adrenal hyperplasia (CAH) and Cushings syndrome potentially this year followed by Phase 3 data in 2027 - the acquisition has been debated by investors on valuation. We also expect Phase 1/2 CF data from next-generation CFTR modulator VX-828 and initial Phase 1/2 DM1 data in 2H and Phase 3 inaxaplin data in APOL1-mediated kidney disease (AMKD) in early-2027 (we also expect Phase 2 inaxaplin data in the co-morbid diabetes and moderate proteinuria populations in 2H, albeit are more cautious given less supporting data and following mixed data from MAZE).

We expect an in-line quarter (GSe/company-compiled total revenue of \$3,155mn/\$3,219mn; non-GAAP EPS of \$4.57/\$4.70) and note VRTX has historically raised revenue guidance on 2Q EPS, outside of 2Q25 (FY26 total revenue of \$12.95bn-\$13.1bn (+8.5% YoY at the midpoint); GSe/consensus of \$13.1bn/\$13.0bn) with revenue typically meeting consensus, and earnings per share either meeting or exceeding consensus. We model for 2Q Alyfrek revenue of \$490mn vs. company-compiled consensus of \$515mn. We expect questions on the call on: 1) the aforementioned SION data and VRTX's approach to further clinical innovation in CF, 2) povetacicept pre-launch activities, noting VRTX is building an initial salesforce covering nephrologists who see >90% of US patients (estimated at 120-150, larger than competitor VERA and Otsuka salesforces of 80/100, respectively), 3) the probability-of-success for inaxaplin in AMKD, where we see positive readthrough from the Phase 2 data published in the New England Journal of Medicine, and 4) the commercial outlook for the CRNX assets, Palsonify and atumelnant (VRTX sees a path to \$5bn+ in revenue). We also look for any potential updates on accounting for the proposed CRNX acquisition, which VRTX expects to close in 3Q and become accretive to non-GAAP operating income by FY29.

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We model for an in-line 2Q earnings report. We expect a mostly in-line quarter (GSe and company-compiled total revenue of ~\$3.2bn; non-GAAP EPS of \$4.57/\$4.70). VRTX historically raises revenue guidance on 2Q EPS, noting 2Q25 as the exception (FY26 total revenue of \$12.95bn-\$13.1bn (+8.5% YoY at the midpoint); GSe/consensus of \$13.1bn/\$13.0bn).

Exhibit 1: GSe vs. Consensus

	2Q26		FY26		Guidance	FY27	
	GSe	Cons.	GSe	Cons.		GSe	Cons.
VRTX							
Trikafta WW sales (\$mn)	\$2,440	\$2,480	\$9,985	\$9,734		\$9,650	\$9,158
Alyftrek	\$490	\$515	\$2,169	\$2,280		\$3,130	\$3,378
Casgevy revenue (\$mn)	\$57	\$60	\$243	\$242		\$443	\$411
Jornavx (acute pain)	\$45	\$49	\$234	\$214		\$553	\$552
povetacicept (IgAN)	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$1		\$174	\$102
Total Product Revenue (\$mn)	\$3,155	\$3,219	\$13,099	\$13,037	\$12.95-\$13.1bn	\$14,338	\$14,309
Non-GAAP EPS	\$4.57	\$4.70	\$19.61	\$19.16		\$22.90	\$21.33

Source: Company data, FactSet, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Catalysts: Following the proposed acquisition of CRNX, investors look to understand the revenue outlook for CRNX's Palsonify and Ph3 atumelnant in addition to the catalyst path for atumelnant and other acquired pipeline assets in thyroid eye disease and Graves' disease. For atumelnant, the next anticipated catalysts are OLE data in congenital adrenal hyperplasia (CAH) in 2H26+, which could serve to assuage investor debates on prior liver toxicities (we are not concerned), and Ph3 data likely in 2027 per the primary completion date on clinicaltrials.gov. Outside of the CRNX assets, most focus continues to be on near-term catalysts in kidney disease/autoimmune indications, including: 1) Ph2 inaxaplin data in APOL1-mediated kidney disease (AMKD) in mid-2026, in the subset of patients with moderate proteinuria and Type 2 diabetes, 2) approval and launch of povetacicept in IgAN per the November 30 PDUFA and 3) Ph3 48-week interim analysis inaxaplin data in primary AMKD in early-2027. We also monitor VRTX's innovation cycle in CF in the context of the competitive landscape (SION's NBD1 stabilizers), with initial Ph1 data from VX-828, a next-generation 3.0 CFTR corrector, in people with CF (2H). In addition, Ph1/2 data from VX-670 in DM1 (muscle strength, splicing) serves as an upside lever.

Exhibit 2: Key catalysts into 2027

Company	Timing	Drug	Event
VRTX	-	povetacicept in gMG	Ph2 initiated in gMG, driving enrollment + dosing
	-	povetacicept in pMN	Enrollment in Ph2 pivotal trial complete and Ph3 initiated; drive Ph3 advancement
	2H26	VX-670 (DM1)	Ph1/2 data (splicing, muscle strength)
	2H26	inaxaplin	Ph2 AMPLIFIED study data in AMKD with moderate proteinuria or diabetes
	2H26	VX-828 (next-gen CFTR modulator)	Ph1/2 data in CF patients
	2H26+	atumelnant	OLE data in CAH (estimated)
	November 30th	povetacicept	PDUFA in IgAN
	early-2027	inaxaplin	Ph3 48-week interim analysis data in AMKD; potential AA filing thereafter
	2Q27+	suzetrigine	Ph3 data in DPN
	Mid-2027	atumelnant	Ph3 data in CAH (timing anticipated)
	2027	atumelnant	Ph3 data in carcinoid syndrome (timing anticipated)

Source: Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and Risks

VRTX (Buy): Our 12-month PT of \$652 is based on a 100% DCF value (8% WACC, 1%

TGR). Risks: Downside risks: Clinical/technology setbacks – Failure to execute across the earlier stage pipeline would present risk to VRTX's future growth outlook outside the CF franchise. Failure to secure reimbursement for CF therapies ex-US. Failure to obtain regulatory approval and lack of commercial success for later-stage pipeline assets would pose significant downside risks to our sales estimates. Competition — We note potential competitive threats to the CF franchise and gene editing technologies. Failure to protect IP portfolio — We assume IP coverage into the late 2030s, and failure to extend these patents would represent downside to our estimates. Pricing/reimbursement pressure — Similar to all large-cap biopharma companies, downward pressure on price and/or reimbursement challenges on recently launched or existing drugs would represent downside risk to product revenues.

VRTX	12m Price Target: \$652.00	Price: \$477.36	Upside: 36.6%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$121.2bn Enterprise value: \$111.2bn 3m ADTV: \$703.2mn United States Americas Biotechnology M&A Rank: 3	Revenue (\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	12,001.3	13,098.8	14,338.3	16,448.6
	EBIT (\$ mn)	4,383.1	5,144.3	5,833.9	7,408.1
	EPS (\$)	4,173.3	4,929.6	5,555.7	7,312.0
	EPS (\$)	18.40	19.61	22.90	29.57
	P/E (X)	24.1	24.3	20.8	16.1
	EV/EBITDA (X)	24.7	21.7	18.2	13.7
	FCF yield (%)	2.8	4.0	5.2	4.3
	Dividend yield (%)	—	—	—	—
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(1.2)	(1.9)	(2.8)	(2.9)
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (\$)		4.47	4.57	5.18	5.39

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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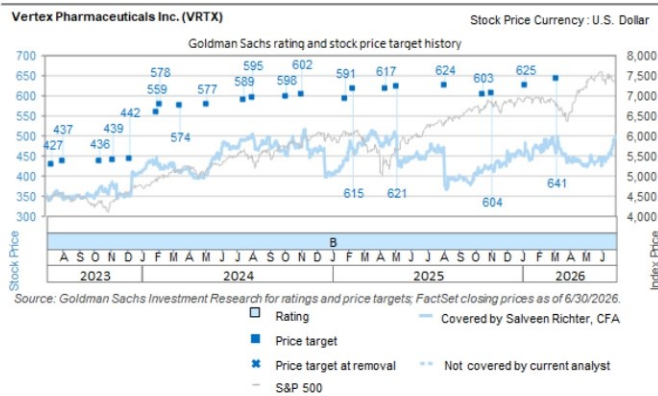
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Vertex Pharmaceuticals Inc. (VRTX)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
20-Jul-26	652.00	480.50
09-Mar-26	641.00	460.87
08-Jan-26	625.00	469.68
04-Nov-25	604.00	421.67
17-Oct-25	603.00	416.81
05-Aug-25	624.00	374.98
06-May-25	621.00	450.03
14-Apr-25	617.00	495.83
11-Feb-25	615.00	455.22
27-Jan-25	591.00	443.88
05-Nov-24	602.00	499.88
04-Oct-24	598.00	455.31
02-Aug-24	595.00	494.46
16-Jul-24	589.00	488.98
07-May-24	577.00	410.24
15-Mar-24	574.00	407.69
06-Feb-24	578.00	416.13
31-Jan-24	559.00	433.38
10-Dec-23	442.00	350.15
07-Nov-23	439.00	378.25
13-Oct-23	436.00	371.00
02-Aug-23	437.00	358.40

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